Ishkhan Khchoian

Product Manager — conversational AI, discovery & 0-to-1

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Armenian (native) · Russian (native) · English (C1)

IN SHORT

What I bring to product is six years of discovery by necessity: sitting with people under stress, pulling out requirements they could not articulate themselves, and then rebuilding the process around what I found. Until February 2026 I owned the hardest cases at a U.S. immigration company and coordinated eight paralegals; in February 2026 I left a stable legal career to move into product properly. Since then: a U.S.-perspective project management course run by the Yerevan American Corner with the U.S. Embassy (Jul–Aug 2026), second place at HackNation and my COO role at SayWhen.am, a working AI voice-agent product. Conversational AI is not a box I am ticking for this application — it is what I already chose to work on.

One interview is enough — give me 30 minutes and a real problem from your team, and you'll see how I work.

WHY THIS ROLE SPECIFICALLY

- **Conversational AI.** As COO of SayWhen.am I work on AI voice agents and RAG systems for B2B — vertical-specific, aimed at enterprise clients and tenders. I have spent my own time on where these interfaces break: retrieval quality, handover to a human, and what users actually say versus what you expect them to say.
- **Discovery and user research.** Client intake was my daily work for six years — structured interviews with people who describe a symptom and not the problem. That is the same muscle a product discovery call uses, and I have run it several hundred times.
- **Turning ideas into clear specs.** At M&M I rewrote the internal workflow — templates, checklists, hand-offs — and it became how the team works by default. Writing something precise enough that other people can execute it without me is the part I enjoy most.
- **Many threads at once.** 200+ live cases and 30+ hearings a week at an arbitration court, up to 12 complex filings at once, live events for up to 3,000 people. A fast-moving team will not overload me.
- **Founder-adjacent work.** I am used to being the person a principal delegates the ambiguous half of the problem to — I stood in for the team lead at Shamayev and was the escalation point at M&M.
- **Time zone.** Yerevan is UTC+4: my afternoon is your morning, so a CET/CEST team gets a solid overlap without either of us working nights.

PRODUCT & TECH TRACK

- **SayWhen.am, COO** — working AI voice-agent product (demo on request); RAG for B2B, with separate verticals per industry.
- **HackNation** — 2nd place, local pitches; competed in the on-site final at TUMO Labs, Yerevan (July 2026).
- **42 Yerevan — Piscine**, Nov–Dec 2025. Passed selection; one month of C and peer-reviewed projects, done while holding a full-time job.
- **Startup Seaside Summit** — participant.
- **Project management, U.S. perspective** — "Project Management with a U.S. Perspective: Skills for Global Success," Yerevan American Corner, a joint program of the U.S. Embassy Yerevan and the City Central Isahakyan Library; Jul 21 – Aug 21, 2026, in person, Certificate of Achievement. Earlier: PM Club, 52 hours (2023).

SKILLS

- **Product:** user interviews and discovery · writing requirements, user stories and acceptance criteria · backlog grooming · roadmap input · experiment design · metric definition and tracking · competitor and market research

- **Delivery:** scope and timelines · Agile/Scrum · Gantt charts · risk tracking · SOPs and checklists people actually follow · cross-functional coordination
- **Analytical:** six years of legal analysis: reading a dense corpus, finding the one clause that decides the outcome, and defending the reasoning in writing
- **Tools:** Jira · Confluence · Notion · Trello · Monday · Bitrix24 · amoCRM · Google Analytics · Google Workspace · basic C

EXPERIENCE

Freelance — legal & project work · PM training Feb 2026 – present

- Legal: IP assignment for works of popular musicians; corporate structure for a crypto trader; advised on opening a crypto-exchange office in Armenia.
- Projects: COO of the **SayWhen.am** startup (AI voice agents); business research for a water production line; CPA/affiliate manager (under NDA); sale of family real estate; designed a U.S. client-acquisition pilot for **Karas Systems** (B2B go-to-market consultancy).

Senior Case Manager — M&M Document Preparation Jun 2025 – Feb 2026

- Owned the most complex, highest-value cases end to end (O-1B, EB-3, E-2) — intake, strategy, evidence, submission — up to **12 running at once**.
- Coordinated **8 paralegals** on their parallel caseloads; escalation point on hard problems.
- Rewrote the internal workflow — templates, checklists, hand-offs — and it became the team default.

Event / Project Manager — Hosq Corp. Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

- Shipped live events for 100–3,000 people — several in parallel, on dates that could not slip.
- Ran vendors, logistics, scheduling and the day-of operation.

Project Manager — Qanon Construction Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Client communication, sales coordination, timelines and follow-through across daily operations.

Paralegal, autonomous caseload — Bloomrich Law Firm Nov 2023 – Aug 2024

- Hired on the strength of previous results and given full ownership of how my cases were run.

Senior Paralegal — Shamayev Business Law Corp. Feb 2023 – Oct 2023

- Built and ran the **Paralegal Academy**, an internal training program — from curriculum to delivery; the materials went on to serve **50+ people**.
- Trusted with the firm's key cases and with standing in for the team lead.

Judge's Associate — Arbitration Court Nov 2021 – Dec 2022

- **200+ live cases, 30+ hearings a week**, three roles at once — sustained parallel workload without losing track of a single case.

Assistant Lawyer — Bar Association · Administrator / Project Manager — LLC "SIS" 2015 – 2021

- Contract analysis and claims work; before that 15+ construction and retail projects — teams of 2–20, contractors, procurement, tenders.

EDUCATION & OTHER

- **Bachelor of Law, with honors** — North-Eastern State University, 2021.
- **Civil Law, Faculty of Law** — St. Petersburg State University, 2016.
- **Highload++** (700 attendees) — organizing team, led 12 people; special assignments and a performance bonus.
- **Ethos Foundation** — HQ coordinator, Sep 2023 – Oct 2024; humanitarian distribution to ~100 families a day.